

ONE WEEK OUT

- ☐ Confirm the table: load-in time, what the fee includes, whether a chair comes with it
- ☐ Look up the venue's exact sales tax rate - it follows the venue address, not your home address
- ☐ Seller's permit sorted. A temporary permit is free from the CDTPA, applied for online, usually issued immediately
- ☐ Write down your permit number. The organizer must collect it before they can rent you the space
- ☐ Set your break-even number: (table fee + travel + food) divided by your gross margin
- ☐ Pull and price your inventory. Anything unpriced does not sell

NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐ Build the change float: \$150-200, weighted heavily toward \$1s and \$5s
- ☐ Charge everything - phone, battery pack, card reader, lights
- ☐ Price stickers on every single item, no exceptions
- ☐ Load the car in reverse order: what you set up first goes in last
- ☐ Decide your last-hour discount policy now, in writing, while you are calm
- ☐ Print this sheet and bring your inventory tracker

THE PACK LIST

DISPLAY

- ☐ Tablecloth long enough to reach the floor
- ☐ Risers to get \$5-40 singles up to eye level
- ☐ Your own light, plus extension cord and power strip
- ☐ Two signs maximum: your name, and your deal
- ☐ Locking case for anchors and anything you would hate to lose
- ☐ Bulk boxes and binders for the browse zone

HANDLING

- ☐ Penny sleeves, toppers, team bags
- ☐ Rubber bands and dividers
- ☐ Empty boxes for what you buy at the show

MONEY

- ☐ Change float in a zip pouch on your belt, not a cash box on the table
- ☐ Card reader, charged, with the app already logged in
- ☐ A backup way to take payment
- ☐ Small sign listing the payment methods you accept

YOU

- ☐ Water, and food you can eat standing up
- ☐ Phone battery pack
- ☐ Pens, a Sharpie, and a notepad
- ☐ Business cards or a QR code to your list

FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU GO

Table fee \$_____ + Travel \$_____ + Food \$_____ = Total costs \$_____

Total costs / your gross margin (0.35 is a fair starting assumption) = BREAK-EVEN GROSS \$_____

That is what you have to sell just to get your money back. If it is more than you have ever sold in one day, find a cheaper table. Run it exactly at vendlytcg.com/tools/profit-calculator, and track the real result in the free inventory template.

SHOW DAY, HOUR BY HOUR

- ☐ **LOAD-IN:** arrive at the vendor door time, not the buyer door time. Setting up while customers watch costs you the first hour
- ☐ **BEFORE DOORS:** know your wholesale number on everything. The first trades of the day are vendor-to-vendor and you will be asked
- ☐ **FIRST TWO HOURS:** peak traffic. Stay standing, stay off your phone, let people dig. Answer questions, do not hover
- ☐ **MIDDAY:** restock the front edge. The browse zone empties fastest and a picked-over box stops earning
- ☐ **LAST HOUR:** deals get made in both directions. Stick to the discount policy you wrote down last night
- ☐ **ALL DAY:** log every sale as it happens. Memory at 4pm is not a record-keeping system

BEFORE YOU UNPACK THE CAR

- ☐ GROSS SALES - everything that came in, cash and card
- ☐ COST OF WHAT SOLD - your cost basis, not the ask price
- ☐ TOTAL SHOW COSTS - table fee, travel, food, payment fees
- ☐ NET PROFIT - and the real question: does this room earn a repeat booking?

NOTES - WHAT TO FIX NEXT TIME